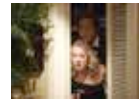




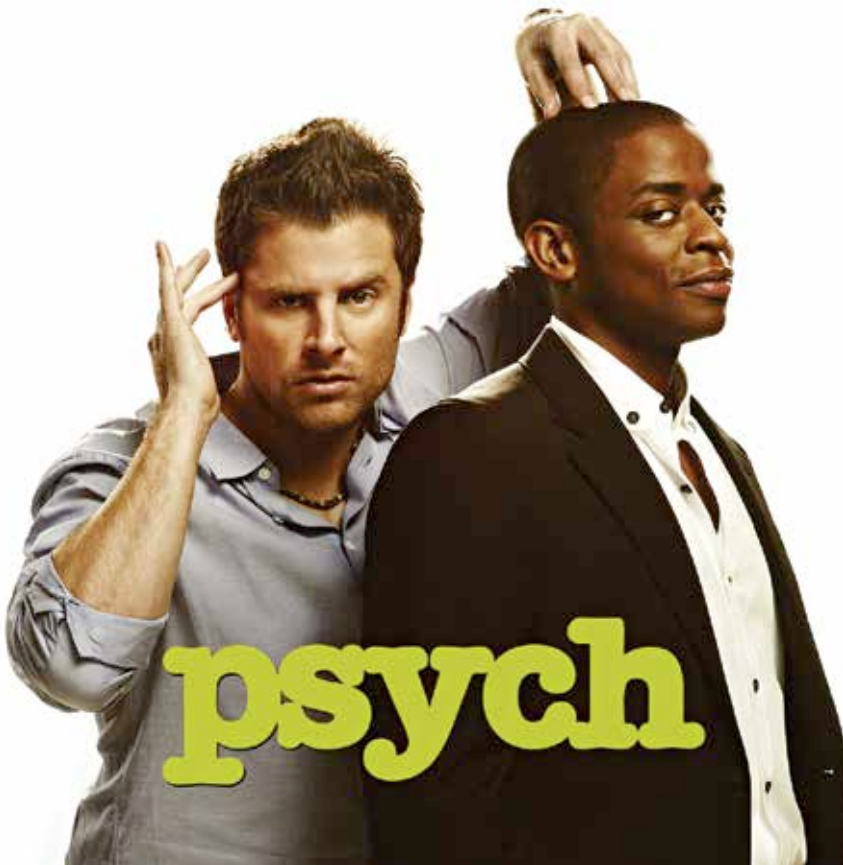
### A masterclass in cameo

Here's an interesting list of 32 guest stars in Psych that you probably don't remember. <http://digit.in/nov20-77>



### Recommendations

If you liked Psych, here's some other shows similar to Psych, for you to check out. <http://digit.in/nov20-78>



## An overly geeky show that is underrated

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e cannot really call Psych underrated because it has a critic's score of 89% and an audience

score of 92% on Rotten Tomatoes. Maybe it is better to call it underappreciated or just underviewed. If you have not seen it, then you are in for a treat because there are eight seasons of awesomeness waiting for you. But if you have seen it, then you know that everything we like about shows and movies today, Psych actually did better – 80s nostalgia, mashups, self awareness, pop culture references, and remakes. It checks all the right boxes, and we will be going through

this checklist in this spoiler free article. Shawn Spencer is like a modern day Sherlock Holmes and Gus is his black Watson. Shawn has a photographic memory and exceptional observation skills, but his deductions have much to be desired, and he pretends to be a psychic. Every episode has the same template. A flashback sequence first shows something that happened to young Shawn and Gus when they were kids. Cut to present, the lesson learned as a kid has to be applied to an adult problem.

### 80S NOSTALGIA

Sure there are many shows in this space. Why Psych does it better is that it does not add a synthwave soundtrack, scan lines and VHS effects on the footage. The costumes are period appropriate only in the flashback sequences. Otherwise, it is just a deep love for the greatest decade, that shows up in the conversations that Shawn and

Gus have. The brilliance of Psych is that it does not resort to the look and feel of the content to bring about the sense of nostalgia, the characters are experiencing it all the time themselves. That approach of incorporating 80s nostalgia directly into the dialogues, in a metatextual manner through the story telling, and in the short flashback sequences keeps the series contemporary. It is also palatable and approachable for those who have not been exposed to 80s Americana, which is better than say Stranger Things, Red Oaks or Freaks and Geeks. The best thing is that even though Shawn and Gus are grown up, they continue to behave very much like the kids from the 80s, saying “suck it” in increasingly elaborate and musical ways, using finger guns, and being worried about cooties.

### POP CULTURE REFERENCES

Psych is stuffed to the brim with pop culture references, ranging from obscure ones such as Enemy Mine or Slither to relatively popular ones such as Star Trek or Terminator. The main cast seems to be obsessed with Billy Zane (from Phantom) for some reason, and there are many references to The Mentalist. This is an eclectic selection of references, one that is bound to please many fans. The best thing about Psych is that the “easter eggs” are very different from the pop culture references, a line that can be easy to blur when not done properly. For example, watch out for pineapples hidden in the episodes. The series has acquired a cult following, obviously, who call themselves the Psychos. Psychos try to hunt down and catalogue every pineapple in the series, which is an ongoing effort.

The series is self referential when it needs to be, along the lines of Boston Legal, where the references actually makes sense for the characters in the situation. It is meta without breaking the fourth wall. Also, the references are not